

POL-BIZ-004 - Seller Escalation and Communication Policy

Policy | Business

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1. Purpose

This policy defines how a seller-affecting issue is prioritised, who communicates with the seller, what the seller is entitled to be told, and how commercial remedies are decided.

It complements the Incident Escalation Procedure, which routes issues internally. This policy governs the seller-facing side of the same events.

2. Scope

Applies to any issue that affects a seller's ability to trade, to be paid correctly, or to rely on platform data, whether reported by the seller or detected internally.

Applies to all four seller accounts regardless of tier. Tier affects communication cadence and remedy thresholds; it does not affect entitlement to accurate information.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
Seller-affecting issue	Any issue with a consequence visible to the seller or its customers
Irreversible harm	Harm that cannot be undone within the response window
Named counterpart	The seller-side individual recorded for the account
Communication cadence	The agreed frequency of updates during a live issue
Remedy	A commercial action taken to address seller loss
Platform-caused	An issue whose cause lies in platform systems or decisions

4. Priority Rules

R-1. Priority is determined by whether harm is **irreversible** and whether it is **still accruing**, not by the number of records affected.

Priority	Condition
P1	Irreversible harm accruing now, or a shared trading path degraded
P2	Material harm, recoverable, affecting a single account or flow
P3	Incorrect behaviour with deferred or limited consequence

Priority	Condition
P4	Cosmetic or single-record issue

- R-2. Category characteristics override volume. A fulfilment failure on a perishable account is P1 regardless of order count, because a missed delivery slot destroys the goods rather than delaying them.
- R-3. A dropship account has no ability to inspect goods before dispatch. Catalogue attribute defects on such accounts escalate faster than the record count alone would imply, because the seller cannot detect or correct the error in its own operation.
- R-4. Priority may be raised mid-issue. Raising priority when commercial scale becomes clear is expected behaviour, not an admission of misclassification.

5. Communication Rules

- R-5. The seller is entitled to be told, in this order of importance: that the issue is acknowledged, what is known, what is being done, and when the next update will come. An update with no new information is still an update.
- R-6. Support owns communication during a live issue. Business owns communication about commercial consequences. These must not be mixed: a support update should not speculate about remedies, and a commercial conversation should not substitute for a technical update.

Priority	Seller update cadence
P1	Hourly, or as agreed with the account
P2	At escalation, at root cause, at resolution
P3	At resolution
P4	At resolution

- R-7. Where an account has an agreed cadence, it overrides the table and is recorded against the account.
- R-8. A holding response must be factual. Setting an expectation that cannot be honoured is worse than a neutral response. Support must not indicate a likely commercial outcome.
- R-9. Where an issue is platform-wide but reported by one seller, that fact is communicated to the reporting seller. It is relevant to them and withholding it is misleading.
- R-10. Where a seller's own systems contributed to an issue, this is stated directly and with evidence, in a joint technical discussion rather than in a written notice.

A flash sale incident in July 2026 involved both a missing platform circuit breaker and an unbounded client retry policy at the seller. Both contributions were stated plainly in a joint post-incident call, and the outcome was a shared remediation plan rather than an argument about fault. Stating only the platform's contribution would have left the seller exposed to a recurrence.

6. Detection Rules

- R-11. Where an issue was detected by the seller rather than by the platform, this is recorded as a detection gap and raised as a preventive action. It is not treated as a successful outcome merely because the issue was resolved.
- R-12. A seller who reports a systemic defect is not disadvantaged by having reported it. Metrics affected by a defect the seller reported must not be used against that seller's account standing.

Rule R-12 exists because a seller reported a platform catalogue defect in August 2026, and the return rate caused by that defect subsequently triggered an automated suspension of their account in September 2026.

7. Remedy Rules

R-13. Remedy decisions belong to Business. Support and Operations do not offer, imply or negotiate remedies.

R-14. Where an issue is platform-caused, costs arising directly from it are absorbed by the platform. This includes reverse logistics arising from a platform catalogue defect, tax correction costs, and reserve adjustments applied as a consequence of a platform defect.

R-15. Recovery of an overpayment from a seller who did not cause the error is staged across settlement cycles, without interest or fee.

R-16. Compensation for lost sales is assessed case by case and is not automatic. Reinstatement, waiver of consequential charges and a credible fix are the default remedy set.

R-17. Where an automated action against an account is later found to be platform-caused, the event is recorded as platform-caused in the account risk history and excluded from future risk assessment for that account.

8. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Support	Acknowledgement, factual updates, evidence gathering, resolution confirmation
Business	Commercial conversations, remedy decisions, account standing
Engineering	Technical explanation suitable for the seller's technical staff
Operations	Recovery outcome and verification confirmation
Account manager	Single point of accountability for the seller relationship

R-18. Where an account has no assigned account manager under the seller scope model, Operations holds the relationship and consults Business at review points. The seller is still entitled to a single named point of contact.

9. Exceptions

E-1. Priority may be set below section 4 where a compensating control bounds the harm, the reasoning is recorded, and Business is informed.

E-2. Communication cadence may be reduced by agreement with the seller.

E-3. Technical detail may be withheld where it is classified RESTRICTED. The seller is still told the operational facts that affect them, including any action they must take.

E-4. No exception may waive R-11 (detection gaps recorded) or R-12 (a reporting seller is not disadvantaged).

10. Escalation

Situation	Escalate to	Timeframe
P1 declared	Business notified	30 minutes
Seller disputes the platform's account of an issue	Business	1 working day

Situation	Escalate to	Timeframe
Seller requests compensation	Business	2 working days
Automated action against an account	Operations and Business	30 minutes
Communication cadence missed on a P1	Account manager	On breach
Seller escalates above the named counterpart	Business	Immediately

11. Enforcement

Priority, cadence adherence and detection source are recorded on every seller-affecting issue and reviewed at the quarterly account review.

Detection gaps are tracked as preventive actions with owners and dates. A quarter in which most issues on an account were seller-detected is treated as a monitoring failure and is escalated to the policy owner.

Remedy decisions taken outside Business are treated as policy breaches and are reviewed individually.

12. Review History

Version	Date	Change	Owner
1.0	2023-08-15	Initial escalation and communication policy	Business
1.1	2025-02-20	Cadence table; category-based priority overrides	Aditya Verma
2.0	2026-07-28	Joint attribution rules; shared remediation guidance	Aditya Verma
2.1	2026-09-22	Detection gap and reporting-seller protection rules added	Aditya Verma

Next scheduled review: March 2027.